



Retouching Pictures with Photoshop

Remove red eyes, adjust colours, or crop as you like—with Photoshop, fine-tune your photos and make them look natural and lively

Digital cameras cannot give you perfect photos unless you use professional accessories—tripods, soft-lights, and lenses specific to the nature of the photograph. Adobe Photoshop is a must-have tool for any and every budding photography enthusiast. It gives you the freedom to make the pictures look more natural and lively than they are, remove red eyes, or do away with unwanted elements.

STEP 1 Adjust Brightness And Contrast

If you take a photograph from the wrong angle or direction, the subject will be too dark. Depending on what angle the photo was taken at, adjust its brightness to make the darker areas

more visible. Adjust the contrast to lend more depth. Open the file in Photoshop, select **Image > Adjustment > Brightness and Contrast**. Adjusting the contrast sharpens the image and reveals finer details.

STEP 2 Colour Level Correction

Often, pictures that you have taken end up with either too much or too little colour. This happens due to a low-quality CCD, or an overcast of a nearby reflection. You easily fix this using colour-level correction tools. In the image below, there is too much of green. Choose **Image > Adjustment > Levels**. Go to the Channel dropdown, choose Green. Next, slowly drag the little white knob under the

graph towards the left to reduce the amount of green. This feature controls the lighter colours. Now, take the middle grey knob and move it to the right to adjust the mid-tones. The black knob controls the shadows and the darker areas.

STEP 3 Red-Eye Reduction

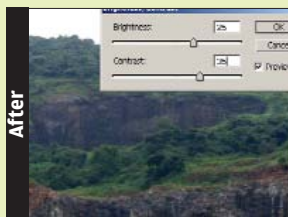
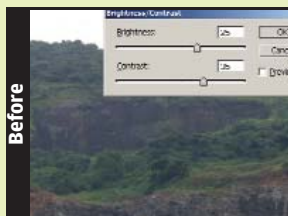
Often people forget to turn on the Red Eye Reduction feature while shooting humans. This is exactly what happened in this picture. Select the Red Eye using the Elliptical Selection Marquee tool. To smoothen its edge, set the Feather Radius somewhere between five to 10 pixels by selecting **Selection > Feather**. Next, open **Image > Adjustment > Hue and**

Saturation. Reduce the saturation by dragging the slider to the left. This makes the red portion a little darker. After this, decrease the lightness by pulling its slider to the right.

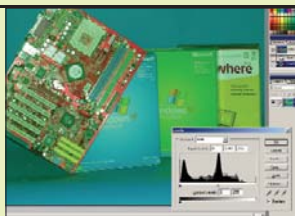
STEP 4 Cropping and Rotating

If you want to remove unnecessary details, select the Crop tool, and select the area that you want to keep. Sometimes, photos come tilted if you don't use a tripod. You can orient the tilted picture. Drag the edges of the selection to rotate it.

Perfect! Of course, there is no substitute to taking educated, well-arranged photographs. Nevertheless, Photoshop is always there to enhance the quality of your digital photos!



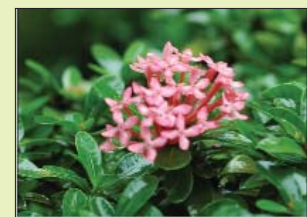
After the brightness and contrast are adjusted, the photo has more depth and better colour



Notice how the all the colours here look balanced. The green overcast is now gone



Red-eye removal is as easy as the problem



Crop and rotate pictures to compensate for badly framed photos



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